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Teaching Design Check

Eleven questions your education lead should be able to answer before anyone books a room. Simple to ask. Hard to answer well. You don't have to answer every row yourself, but you need to know someone can. If nobody can, you've found the gap.

How to use it. Tick one box for each row: ✓ ready, ~ partly, ✗ not yet or N/A. Then write one line on *where's the evidence?* A tick without a note doesn't count.

Top right of each row: when to tackle it (**Start**, **Next** or **Then**: see right), and how much Teaching That Lands covers: ● taught, ◐ touched on, ○ not covered. Where a row is ○ and it matters, involve someone who knows that area. Don't skip the row.

Lots of gaps? Start here. Pick one session and one row to start. Organisations change slowly: expect years, not weeks.

1. **Start:** rows 1, 4, 10. Three questions on every request.
2. **Next:** rows 2, 5, 6, 7. Better sessions: what the programme teaches.
3. **Then:** rows 3, 8, 9, 11. The system: needs an education lead. Basic accessibility can't wait.

BEFORE

1 Is teaching the answer?

Start · ◐

What should people do differently, what would show it (ideally something you already measure), and why don't they do it now?

CONSIDER Could they do it if their life depended on it? Then it isn't skill: look at kit, staffing, workload, the form, the culture. Would a checklist, a pocket card or a process change do it instead? Cost: people × hours, plus travel and backfill. What else could those hours buy?

RED FLAGS *The request arrives as a format ("a study day on X"). The date is set before the problem is.*

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

2 Learners and context

Next · ◐

Who exactly, how many, and what can they already do?

CONSIDER What they've been taught before, and what was tried before. Nights, part-time and bank staff; staff educated overseas; English as an additional language; neurodivergent learners. Do they know why it matters? Choosing to come, or sent? Do some groups do less well now?

RED FLAGS *"All staff". Nobody has spoken to a learner. Mandatory for everyone, whatever they can already do.*

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

3 Co-production

Then · ○

Who shaped this, apart from the person who asked for it?

CONSIDER Two or three learners and their managers. Patients or carers where care is affected (budget for their time and expenses). Whoever will deliver it. Something that already exists, rather than building it again.

RED FLAGS *Designed in a meeting with no learners in it. A patient story used as decoration, not as a voice.*

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

4 Outcomes

Start · ● Session 3

One to three things people will be able to *do*, with verbs you could watch?

CONSIDER Which level of Miller's pyramid does each reach? Can a "does" outcome be reached in one session? Some ideas take time to click. Know it by heart, or know where to find it?

RED FLAGS *"Understand", "be aware of", "appreciate". Ten outcomes for an hour.*

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

5 Who's teaching it?

Next · ○

Who will deliver it, are they prepared and supported, and who other than the designer has checked it?

CONSIDER Protected time to prepare. Do they know the subject *and* how to teach it? A colleague to observe and give feedback. Their own development: a teaching qualification, or Advance HE Fellowship (recognition for university teaching, useful in split clinical and university roles).

RED FLAGS *The subject expert is told to "do a session" with no time to prepare. The designer is the only one who checked it.*

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

DURING

6 Format and activities

Next · ● Session 2 (activities) · ○ (format)

Is a session the right shape? Will learners practise the outcome, somewhere it's safe to get it wrong?

CONSIDER A huddle, simulation, teaching on the job, e-learning, or a pocket card? Short sessions spread out, or one day? A good and a poor example; realistic practice with room for mistakes; a briefing before and a debrief after. Other professions in the room? Games: a quiz helps mostly through retrieval; competition suits some, not all.

RED FLAGS The agenda is a list of speakers. "E-learning, so it's done." A game nobody can link to an outcome.

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

7 Slides and materials

Next · ● Session 1

Does every slide earn its place? Is the clinical content right and up to date?

CONSIDER Cut the clutter; a picture with your voice. A one-page summary or pocket card instead of printed slides? Checked against current policy and guidance by whoever owns it. Permission for every image.

RED FLAGS 60 slides for an hour. The slides are the handout. Nobody knows which version of the policy they teach.

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

8 Accessible and inclusive

Then (basics now) · ◐ Session 1

Can everyone take part fully, and benefit equally?

CONSIDER Adjustments asked about beforehand. Plain language, captions, transcripts, dyslexia-friendly materials; e-learning that meets accessibility standards (WCAG). Timing for night staff; cover so nobody's called away; the cost of attending. An equality impact assessment, if you use them.

RED FLAGS "Tell us on the day if you need anything." A video with no captions.

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

9 Assessment, if needed

Then · ◐ Session 3 (evidence) · ○ (formal)

Does it need assessing? If so, does the check match the outcome, and is it fair?

CONSIDER A check to help people learn, or to sign them off? Who owns the sign-off, and are they prepared to assess? Do some groups do worse on it?

RED FLAGS A quiz used to sign off a "does" outcome. A sign-off with nobody prepared to assess.

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

AFTER

10 Back at work

Start · ● Session 3 (after) · ◐ (before)

Will the workplace let people use it, soon, and keep them to it?

CONSIDER **Before:** managers and the team know what's taught and what they'll support; learners know why they're going, and that there's follow-up. **After:** a chance to use it within days; revisit at 30, 60 and 90 days, and refresh it if it's rarely used; a named person and agreed support (a debrief, a huddle, coaching); a job aid where the work happens.

RED FLAGS Success means attendance and smile sheets. "We'll email the slides." Managers hear about it afterwards, if at all.

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

11 Keep it alive

Then · ○

Who owns it, how will it improve, and when is it next reviewed?

CONSIDER Run it once with a small group first. Evaluate *the session*, not only the learners: did it shift the measure from row 1? Pass on problems teaching can't fix. A named owner and a review date; who takes over if they leave?

RED FLAGS The same slides for five years. No review date. The only person who knows the plan is moving on.

☐ ✓ ready ☐ ~ partly ☐ ✗ not yet ☐ N/A Where's the evidence?

Sign-off

Designed by _____ Checked by (not the designer) _____ Date · review date _____

Decision: ☐ Go ☐ Go with changes ☐ Not a teaching problem: pass to _____

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